

The Viral Post Heist.

How I used **Claude Code** and the **Scrape Creators API** to scrape, study, and reverse-engineer **300+ top-performing social posts** in one night, then write and schedule 30 days of content in my voice.

Inside: the method, the exact prompts, the scripts, and the formulas it found. So you can run the same heist on your own competitors.

■ THE RECEIPTS, BEFORE YOU READ ANYTHING

33.1M

Combined plays across 19 Instagram reels analyzed, each over 1M, transcripts pulled

105

TikToks analyzed, including winners hitting 5.9% share rates

106

LinkedIn posts mined for the text-post formula

30

Posts written in my voice and scheduled at 6PM daily. By an AI. In one sitting

Every number in this document comes from my actual runs in August 2026. Nothing is projected, estimated, or made up. That is a rule where I come from.

What actually happened.

One Friday evening I opened **Claude Code** (Anthropic's terminal AI agent), gave it my **Scrape Creators** API key (scrapecreators.com, a public social data API), and typed one instruction:

"Study the top performing content on Instagram. Figure out what makes it work. Build me a repository."

What it actually did, step by step

- 1 Pulled the recent reels of 10 big accounts in my niche (Hormozi, GaryVee, Codie Sanchez, Simon Squibb, Steven Bartlett and five more), plus keyword searches like "ai side hustle" and "chatgpt", plus the trending feed.
- 2 Filtered everything to reels with 1M+ plays posted in the last 30 days: 19 winners, 33.1M combined plays. Saved every raw response so refreshes are free.
- 3 Pulled the full AI transcript and caption of every winner, then wrote a card per post: hook, structure, why it crossed a million.
- 4 Repeated the whole play on TikTok (105 videos) and LinkedIn (106 posts), then extracted the formulas each platform actually rewards.
- 5 Rewrote my real stories on the winning skeletons and scheduled 30 daily LinkedIn posts at 6:00 PM through my publishing tool's API. While I slept.

Total scraping cost: about two dollars in API credits. The AI did the reading, the analyzing, the writing, and the scheduling.

The stack. Three pieces.

Claude Code	Anthropic's terminal AI agent. Any assistant that can execute scripts works; the terminal versions actually run the scrape, not just talk about it.
Scrape Creators API	Public social data over simple API calls. About 1 credit per request, no logins, no cookies, no gray areas. Covers IG, TikTok, YouTube, LinkedIn, Facebook, and the ad libraries.
One evening	The first run is the slow one. Refreshes take minutes, because every response is saved and re-runs are free.

Most people write content by vibes. This method is **measured**. **Patterns across 19 winners are not opinions. They are evidence.**

Five steps. One evening.

1 Pick your targets

Choose 8 to 12 accounts: your competitors, the big names in your niche, and 2 or 3 adjacent accounts whose audience you want. Add 3 to 5 search keywords your customers actually type.

2 Pull the winners

The AI writes a small script that calls the API for each account, saves every response to disk, then filters to posts above a threshold from the last 30 days. My bar: 1M+ plays. Yours can be 10x smaller in a local niche. The method is identical.

```
> python3 pull.py accounts hormozi garyvee codiesanchez ...  
> python3 pull.py search "ai side hustle" "chatgpt"  
> python3 pull.py filter  
19 winners (>= 1,000,000 plays, <= 30d) -> data/winners.json
```

3 Pull the words, not just the numbers

The step almost everyone skips. Metrics tell you WHICH posts won. Captions and transcripts tell you WHY. One API call per winner returns the full spoken transcript of any reel or TikTok. Now the hooks are text you can study, not vibes you remember.

4 Extract the formula

Feed every transcript and caption back to the AI and ask it to find what the winners share: opening lines, structures, lengths, CTA mechanics. This produces your niche's actual playbook. Mine found things I would never have guessed. They are on page 5.

5 Same skeleton, your stories

You do not copy anyone's content. You copy the skeleton and re-body it with your own true stories, your own numbers, your own voice. Then the AI drafts a 30-day calendar and, if your posting tool has an API, schedules everything.

The rule that keeps this honest: steal structures, never sentences. A formula is not plagiarism. It is anatomy.

Copy. Paste. Run.

Written for an AI agent that can run code (Claude Code or similar). If yours cannot, ask it to hand you the scripts to run yourself.

PROMPT 01 • THE SCRAPE

Here is my Scrape Creators API key: [KEY]. Build me a repository of top content in [MY NICHE]. Pull the recent posts of these accounts: [LIST]. Also search these keywords: [LIST]. Save every raw API response to disk so we never pay for the same request twice. Then filter to posts with [THRESHOLD]+ views posted in the last 30 days and rank them. Show me the table.

PROMPT 02 • THE AUTOPSY

For every winner: pull the full transcript and caption. Then write a card per post: the exact opening line, the structure beat by beat, the length, the CTA, and your analysis of why this one crossed [THRESHOLD] when the account's median post did not.

PROMPT 03 • THE FORMULA

Read all the cards together. Find what the winners share that the losers lack: hook patterns with verbatim examples, format structures, duration bands, caption mechanics, CTA mechanics. Write it as a playbook with rules I can follow, each rule backed by the numbers behind it. No generic advice. If the data does not show it, do not write it.

PROMPT 04 • THE REWRITE

Here are 10 true stories from my business: [STORIES]. Take the winning skeletons from the playbook and re-body them with my stories. My voice: [3 ADJECTIVES + A WRITING SAMPLE]. Rules: no invented numbers, no fake claims, hooks under 12 words with a number where possible, one clear CTA. Draft 30 posts.

PROMPT 05 • THE MACHINE

Schedule these 30 posts daily at [TIME] using [MY TOOL]. Confirm each one is scheduled. Then set up a monthly refresh: re-pull the winners, update the playbook, flag any new format breaking out this month.

What the data actually said.

Condensed from my runs. Your niche will differ. That is exactly why you run it yourself.

The universal hook rules. Every 1M+ winner, every platform.

- **A number in the first sentence.** "70% chance." "\$15 billion." "At 27, making \$40,000." Specificity reads as evidence. Vagueness reads as content.
- **Claim first, credentials second.** "The vitamin world is giving the wrong advice"... then "I am a neurologist." Never the bio first.
- **A question the viewer must stay to answer, inside 5 seconds.**
- **Emotional whiplash beats one emotion.** The flip is the hook: complaint into compliment, triumph into tragedy.

Platform physics nobody tells you

On IG, comment-keyword DM gates dominate	11 of 19 one-million-play reels used "Comment WORD and I will DM you X"
Faces matter on Instagram	19 of 19 winners were person-on-camera
On TikTok, shares are the ranking fuel	Top winner: 1.1M shares on 18.9M plays, a 5.9% share rate
TikTok duration is bimodal	Winners run under 15 seconds or 2 to 6 minutes. The 45-second tip video is the dead zone
Carousels are a depth weapon, not reach	One carousel: 1,407 comments on 7,700 likes. Reels never touch that ratio
On LinkedIn, comments-to-likes is the tell	The best creator posts run 30 to 45% comment-to-like ratios, driven by genuine question closers
Small accounts break out with series, not spikes	One account: 164k followers on 86 posts , a named series in every video

■ THE LINKEDIN TEXT FORMULA · THE ONE THIS DOCUMENT'S POST USED ON YOU

Flat absurd opener under 12 words. Short lines. Quoted dialogue as the engine. One real number. A turn where the joke reveals a lesson. A genuine question close. 400 to 1,100 characters. No hashtag soup.

The same heist, pointed at other things.

Scrape, analyze, generate is a loop. Content is just the most visible place to run it.

- **Competitor ads.** The Meta, TikTok, Google and LinkedIn ad libraries are public. Pull every ad your competitor runs and how long each has been live. Longevity means it works. AI extracts their angles before you spend a dollar.
- **Reviews mining.** Scrape every competitor's reviews. AI clusters the complaints. Their one-star reviews are your ad copy and your product roadmap.
- **Pricing and offer intel.** Watch competitor pricing pages change over time, automatically.
- **Hiring signals.** Competitor job posts tell you what they are building next, months early.
- **Breakout radar.** My scripts flag small accounts growing abnormally fast, so you see the format about to win while it is still early.

Things I could build for you.

- **A competitor content radar.** Weekly automated pull of your competitors' best content and ads, delivered as a digest with the "why it worked" analysis included.
- **A content engine in your voice.** Your true stories plus your niche's measured formula, drafted monthly, scheduled automatically, with a comment-gate DM system so posts build your list.
- **Review and market intel dashboards.** Every competitor's reviews, clustered by complaint, refreshed on schedule.
- **AI agents for the boring work.** Intake, quotes, follow-up, meeting notes into tasks. The unglamorous automations that quietly return hours every week.
- **Custom internal tools.** CRMs, client portals, trackers. Built in days, because AI writes most of the code and I make sure it actually works.

Want one of these, or the heist run on your niche?

DM me on LinkedIn (Neil Busque) or visit busqueneil.com. Tell me your niche and your top 3 competitors. I will tell you exactly what I would build and what it costs. No call required.

Who wrote this. Neil Busque, based in New Jersey. IT first, then a decade across every kind of marketing, and now AI lets me build again: CRMs, client portals, automation systems, and content machines like the one in this PDF. This document was, naturally, produced by the same AI that ran the heist.